The Pułtusk Academy of Humanities



ACTA ARCHAEOLOGICA PULTUSKIENSIA
Vol. II

Proceedings of
the Fifth Central European Conference of Egyptologists.
Egypt 2009: Perspectives of Research.
Pułtusk 22-24 June 2009

Edited by Joanna Popielska-Grzybowska,
& Jadwiga Iwaszczuk

Institute of Anthropology and Archaeology

PUŁTUSK 2009

Scientific Editors: Joanna Popielska-Grzybowska, Jadwiga Iwaszczuk
Proof-reading in English by Jo B. Harper & Joanna Popielska-Grzybowska
DTP by Jadwiga Iwaszczuk
Graphics by Jadwiga Iwaszczuk
Cover design by Jakub Affelski

Published with financial support of the Polish Ministry of Education

All rights reserved
© Copyright 2009
by the Pułtusk Academy of Humanities, 2009

Publisher:
The Pułtusk Academy of Humanities
ul. Daszyńskiego 17, 06-100 Pułtusk
tel./fax (+48 23) 692 50 82
e-mail: rektorat@ah.edu.pl
Internet: www.ah.edu.pl

ISBN 978-83-7549-115-9

Realised on behalf of the publisher:
Przedsiębiorstwo Poligraficzno-Wydawnicze "Graf" – Janusz Janiszewski
04-663 Warszawa
ul. Błękitna 87A
tel. 501 376 898
e-mail:janusz.graf@wp.pl

Contents

Preface 7
Karol Myśliwiec, Pułtusk – between Budapest, Cambridge and Warsaw 9
Kamila Braulińska, Some Remarks on Interpreting *Canidae* in Egyptian Art. Predynastic until Late Period 11
Julia Budka, Ankh-Hor Revisited: Study, Documentation and Publication of Forgotten Finds from the Asasif 23
Artur Buszek, Early Dynastic Representations of Dwarfs – Research Perspectives 33
Marcin Czarnowicz, Early Egyptian – Levantine Relations. Perspectives of Research, View from Tell el-Farkha 39
Piotr Czerkwiński, A Genealogy of a Theban Family between 3rd and 1st Century BC 45
Andrzej Ćwiek, The *Bzn*-Substance 51
Jadwiga Iwaszczuk, Surprising *Name Stones* from the Metropolitan House Storeroom, Luxor 55
Krzysztof Jakubiak, Tell Farama, Pelusium. City Urban Planning Reconstruction in the Light of the Last Researches 65
Bożena Józefów, Joanna Popielska-Grzybowska, Preliminary Remarks on the Rites of Passage in the Pyramid Texts 75
Mariusz A. Jucha, The North-Eastern Part of the Nile Delta – Research Perspectives. Polish Archaeological Survey in the Ash-Sharqiyyah Governorate 83
Nicole Kloth, Propylaeum: Virtual Library Classical Studies – Egyptology 89
Piotr Kołodziejczyk, The Nile Delta during the Predynastic and the Early Dynastic Periods – Recent Discoveries and Perspectives 101
Agnieszka Kowalska, Kamil Kuraszkiewicz, Zbigniew Godziejewski, Old Kingdom Burials with Funerary Plaster Masks from Saqqara 107
Adam Łukaszewicz, A Man Speaks to His Soul: Count Jan Potocki (1761-1815) and the Beginnings of Egyptology 113
Agnieszka Mączyńska, How and Why is Pottery Useful for Understanding Archaeology of Predynastic Egypt? A Few Practical Examples from the Site at Tell el-Farkha 123
Szymon Maślak, How to Build in Marshy Lands? – Some Remarks on Brick Constructions in Roman and Byzantine Pelusium 127
Michał Neska, Egyptian Infantry in the New Kingdom – an Iconographical Survey 143
Andrzej Niwiński, The Double Structure of the Entity. The Ancient Egyptian Conception of the Human Being Reconsidered 153
Grzegorz Pryc, Stone Vessels from the Graves of the Tell el-Farkha Site. Seasons 2001-2008. Preliminary Classifications 161
Marta Sankiewicz, Cosmological Frames on the Lunettes in the Temple of Hatshepsut at Deir el-Bahari 171
Nigel Strudwick, Information Technology in Egyptology: the Past and the Future 179
Elena Valtorta, The Ritualised Body: Body Treatment and Ritual Practices in Egyptian Predynastic Burials 195
Dawid F. Wieczorek, Some Remarks on Dates in the Building-*Dipinti* Discovered in the Temple of Hatshepsut at Deir el-Bahari 207
Leszek Zinkow, Egyptian Revival in Central Europe. Research Project Proposal 213

Bożena Józefów, Joanna Popielska-Grzybowska
Pułtusk

Preliminary Remarks on the Rites of Passage in the Pyramid Texts

The splendid tombs of the Old Kingdom have always been simultaneously thought provoking, thrilling and fascinating. They also provoke our ruminations about the nature of the funerary ceremonial and finally provoke us to follow the traces of funerary rites through a sequence of questions concerning the aims and time of such practices, as well as naming them in prescribed senses. This implies, however, a multi-faceted scholarly approach. It shall be assumed that the Pyramid Texts, together with monuments and relics of all conducted ceremonial practices, constitute an inextricably linked contextual integrity and wholeness.

Consequently, the authors of the paper have undertaken an attempt to relate the theories of anthropology of culture to Egyptological knowledge. It is presumed that neither beliefs nor the traces of discovered ritual practices are coincidental, fortuitous collections, but they are characterised by specific order conveyed in/by certain religious principles. Moreover, material sources obtained form cemeteries are without exception 'marked' by the physical/earthly world and the metaphysical/divine one simultaneously. Therefore, one may suppose that – although our knowledge concerning the above-mentioned will remain fragmentary and marked by our contemporary way of perception – various approaches, including the anthropological one, might stimulate studies regarding Egyptian funerary ceremonies.

First and foremost, the authors have concentrated on the Egyptian written sources describing ritual practices of preparation pharaoh's body for the funeral and the 'life' of a deceased king. Both could be divided into stages or passages.

The problem of celebrating rituals in ancient Egypt has been scrutinised frequently,[1] but still may need some scholarly attention.

Consequently, the present authors made a preliminary attempt to specify and analyse model of stages of the pharaoh's journey to the Beyond based on anthropological conceptions of Arnold van Gennep and Victor Turner, namely the rites of passage.[2]

According to van Gennep, this cycle consists of three sequences following each other beginning from the rites of exclusion of the deceased from their present state – their separation (*rites de séparation*) and transitional marginal stage (*rites de marge*) – when

---

[1] K. Sethe, *Übersetzung und Kommentar zu den Altägyptischen Pyramidentexten* I-IV, Glückstadt – Hamburg 1935-1939, *passim*; S.A.B. Mercer, *The Pyramid Texts in Translation and Commentary* I-IV, Chicago 1948, New York – London – Toronto 1952 (hereinafter referred to as: Mercer, *PT in Translation and Commentary*), *passim*; S. Schott, *Bemerkungen zum ägyptischen Pyramidenkult*, Beiträge zur ägyptischen Bauforschung und Altertumskunde V, Cairo 1950, *passim*; A. Piankoff, *The Pyramid of Unas*, Princeton 1968, *passim* and pp. 1-13 in particular; R.O. Faulkner, *The Egyptian Pyramid Texts. Translated into English*, Oxford 1969 (translation of spells 1-759), *passim*; J. Spiegel, *Unas-Pyramide*, ÄA 23, Wiesbaden 1971, *passim*; H. Altenmüller, *Die Texte zum Begräbnisritual in den Pyramiden des Alten Reichs*, ÄA 24, Wiesbaden 1972, *passim*; R. Anthes, Der König als Atum in den Pyramidentexten, *ZÄS* 110 (1983), pp. 1-4; see the sequence of the texts order and consequently rituals order in: J.P. Allen, *The Ancient Egyptian Pyramid Texts*, Writings form the Ancient World 23, Atlanta 2005 (hereinafter referred to as: Allen, *Ancient PT*), *passim*.

[2] A. van Gennep, *Les rites de passage. Étude systématique des cérémonies de la porte et du seuil, de l'hospitalité, de l'adoption, de la grossesse et de l'accouchement, de la naissance, de l'enfance, de la puberté, de l'initiation, de l'ordination, du couronnement des fiançailles et du mariage, des funérailles, des saisons, etc.*, Paris 1909 (hereinafter referred to as: van Gennep, *Les rites de passage*), pp. 209-236 and V. Turner, *Forest of Symbols*, London 1976 (hereinafter referred to as: Turner, *Forest of Symbols*), pp. 94-95.

a person is deprived of any status, called by V. Turner a liminality phase understood as a period of mediation, a suspension between worlds – "neither here nor there." Thus van Gennep's theory of the rites of passage is inextricably linked with the experience of symbolic death[3] in one state as to be able to revivify into another state, a better reality, for instance. The whole cycle is finished by the inclusion phase (*rites de agrégation*), integration, preparation and adoption for a new role while being included into a group, whose status enables it to exist together.

Both scholars presumed the necessity of surpassing symbolic limits as an inseparable part of every rite of initiation.[4] In accordance with this, the life of a human being is subdivided into periods of (symbolic) death and compulsion of travelling on the way leading to the revival in a new reality or form.[5] Consequently one may single out the following sequences of rituals corresponding to rites of separation, margination and aggregation. During separation the subject of a rite is separated from his/her social role and status through isolation from the everyday situation and he or she enters the state of ritual suspension – when he/she is as if beyond society.[6] Separation is characterised by the individual's or groups' movement away from a fixed point in the social structure towards something unknown.

All in all, during the rituals of aggregation a person returns in a different shape, actually a distinguished and different one with diverse status.[7] Thus such rites led to variability, temporary aberration and consequently created a new social order.

This very assumption may influence our scholarly perception and interpretation of the funeral and funerary practices concerning the deceased pharaoh in the Old Kingdom. Some paradigms and rites associated with death can be of some use for our analysis.

Assuming that until the moment of placing the deceased pharaoh in his tomb, he was surrounded by his family, in some way he could have been perceived as being still alive. Thus it is understood as a period of separation and gradual marginalisation. Then most probably funerary rituals including body preparation for a further journey of the king took place. This time was used for embalming. It is to be presumed that the embalming process was perceived as a guarantee of the imperishableness of life. In accordance with the textual sources, one may suppose that the pharaoh was plunged into inertness, though certainly not death. One might ruminate then that it was a state analogous to the one of Atum, the demiurge, just before creation – the primaeval inertness of the creator. Consequently the deceased belongs to the world of the living rather than to the one of the dead. To overcome this "symbolic death" the body of the king should undergo specific rites of restoring the deceased's senses – opening his mouth, eyes and ears to let him do everyday activities.

According to J. Wach, "there is no such aspect of life [in culture societies], which will not be stipulated by prohibitions and religious rites".[8] This phenomenon has a special quality in

---

[3] Turner, *Forest of Symbols*, pp. 94-95. See also: P. Tillich, The Nature of Religious Language, [in:] *Theology of Culture*, New York 1959 (=*Pytanie o Nieuwarunkowane. Pisma z filozfii religii*, Kraków 1994, pp. 140-147; translated by J. Zychowicz); P. Wheelwright, The Archetypal Symbol, [in:] *Perspectives in Literary Symbolism, Yearbook of Comparative Criticism* I, London 1968, pp. 214-243 and J. Popielska-Grzybowska, *The Pyramid Texts as a Source of Topoi in the Coffin Texts*, Warsaw 2007, PhD dissertation in preparation for printing (hereinafter referred to as: Popielska-Grzybowska, *The Pyramid Texts as a Source*)

[4] E. Leach, *Lévi-Strauss*, Warsaw 1989, pp. 81-83. As far as initiation aspects are concerned, see: J. Assmann, Death and Initiation in the Funerary Religion of Ancient Egypt, [in:] W.K. Simpson, *Religion and Philosophy in Ancient Egypt*, YES 3, New Haven – Connecticut 1989, pp. 135-159 and idem, *Tod und Jenseits im Alten Ägypten*, München 2001, pp. 273-284, 459-460.

[5] Cf. different stages and ways of the pharaoh's travelling to the Beyond, for instance: Mercer, *PT in Translation and Commentary* IV, pp. 1-6.

[6] W. Burszta, *Różnorodność i tożsamość. Antropologia jako kulturowa refleksyjność*, (=*Diversity and Identity. Anthropology as Cultural Reflectiveness*) Poznań 2004, p. 105.

[7] *Ibidem*, p. 105.

[8] J. Wach, *Socjologia religii* (=*Sociology of Religion*), Warsaw 1961, p. 67.

connection with death. It applies to examination of ancient Egyptian culture, which seems to be dominated by these themes, but in reality should rather be perceived as glorification, a eulogy of life even. It is achieved through various physical as well as verbal practices aimed at removal of the ultimate, terminal annihilation threat. The Egyptians were very afraid of the fact that their names might be forgotten or their body decomposed on earth, thus barring their entrance into the Beyond. Therefore, much responsibility for the successful apotheosis of the deceased was on the mourners' side. They appear to have had great influence on the deceased's possibility of succeeding in the transition from this to the other world.

These ideas were mirrored in the funerary complexes of the pharaohs. Probably the pyramids of the Old Kingdom were a manifestation of the greatness and immortality of the king and concurrently a host to his spirit on earth permanently. This is why the pyramids and their precincts are an intrinsic source to scholarly attempts to understand funerary rites. They are the *sacrum* sphere constituting presumably a relict of the dramaturgy of the rituals and rites taking place there.

This very study was inspired by James Peter Allen's observation that each pyramid reflects a model of the Beyond, where the Sarcophagus Chamber is *Duat*, the antechamber *Achet* and the Corridor opens into *Pet*.[9] This mirrors the cosmology of the solar passage – that rather of night – from west to east.[10] The moments just before the appearance of the sun, namely dawn, are referred to, as they are analogous to the situation just before creation, when Atum, the self-generated being, from one became three. The climax of these two is the first sunrise repeated day by day – every day. As J.P. Allen noticed, the body of the king is identified with Osiris, which is reflected in the Offering and Resurrection Rituals. The Osiris form is assumed to perform a certain task while proceeding on the way to the hereafter, to revive, come back to life or let revivified by the celebrants.

§ 193a *ḏt.k ḏt nt wnjs pn*
jf.k jf n wnjs pn
§ 193b *ḳsw.k ḳsw wnjs pn*
§ 193c *z.k z(w) wnjs pn z(w) wnjs pn z.k*

"Your body is the body of this Unis,
your flesh is the flesh of this Unis,
your bones are this Unis's bones – you will go shall this Unis go,
shall this Unis go, you will go." (*PT* spell 219 § 193a-c)

The final stage of these metamorphoses,[11] however, obtains the form and place of Atum-the demiurge – the god of gods, the All-comprising completeness of the complete world in him.

Assuming that the deceased stayed among his family until the moment of ushering the dead pharaoh into the tomb, thus he was still among the living. This time was used, *inter alia*, to prepare his body for continuation of life in the other world. It was gained through physical and, above all, symbolic decomposition of the monarch's body,[12] which

[9] J.P. Allen, Reading a Pyramid, [in:] C. Berger, G. Clerc, N. Grimal (eds), *Hommages à Jean Leclant*, BdÉ 106/1, Le Caire 1993 (hereinafter referred to as: Allen, Reading a Pyramid), pp. 5-28.

[10] *Ibidem*, pp. 24-28.

[11] On the meaning of metamorphosis in The Pyramid Texts as well as in the Coffin Texts see: Popielska-Grzybowska, *The Pyramid Texts as a Source*, p. 42 and footnotes 172, 173 there, p. 63 and footnote 223 there, p. 135 footnote 403, p. 182.

[12] See E. Valtorta, The Ritualised Body: Body Treatment and Ritual Practices in Egyptian Predynastic Burials, hereinafter in this book, pp. 195-205 and bibliographical references therein; J. Popielska-Grzybowska, "Twoja

– according to van Gennep – was performed to enable and facilitate the transition form one state into another.[13] The process of embalming could presumably be seen as a guarantee of the imperishableness of his life. In light of the sources, it turns out to be obvious that the pharaoh is plunged into inertness – a death-trance state, but not death itself. He was not treated as truly dead:

§ 134a *hꜣ wnjs nj šm.n.k js mt.tj šm.n.k ꜥnḫ.t*

"O Unis, it is not dead but alive that you have gone away." (*PT* spell 213)

Consequently the deceased would belong to the world of the living rather than to the other world of the dead.[14] In accordance with the theory of the rites of passage, after the period of separation, margination and preparation the body of the dead for the funeral, there came the period of leading the deceased pharaoh into the tomb, in the discussed case, the pyramid. Undoubtedly the ritual of awakening the king and bringing him into being – into life in the Beyond were preceded by the ritual procession. Thus the act of separation – exclusion linked to the margination phase would correspond with the period of bringing the corpse out, thereby symbolising the commencement of his journey, separation from the living and placing him in the Sarcophagus Chamber. The pharaoh was summoned to live by various reality creating spells, for instance:

§ 1898a *j.rs rs NN pn*
§ 1898b *j.rs n.j jnk zꜣ.k j.rs n.j jnk ḥrw srs ṯw*
§ 1899a *ꜥnḫ ꜥnḫ.t NN pn m rn.k pw ḫr ꜣḫjw*
§ 1899b *ḫꜥ.tj m wpjw*
§ *1899c *bꜣ js ḫntj ꜥnḫw sḫm* (*js*) *ḫntj ꜣḫjw*
§ *1899d *sbꜣ js wꜥtj wnm n.f ḫft.f*

"Wake up, wake up, this King/Queen, wake up for me! I am your son; wake up for me, for I am Horus who wakes you up. Live and be alive, o this King/Queen, in this name of yours which is among the spirits – you [have been] appearing as *Wpjw* and as the soul at the head of the living, as the Power at the head of the spirits, as the Lone Star who eats his enemy." (*PT* spell 665 § 1898a-1899d)

or:
§ 654a *jhj jhj ṯz ṯw NN pw*
§ 654b *šzp n.k tpj.k jnḳ n.k ḳsw.k*
§ 654c *sꜣḳ n.k ꜥwt.k*
§ 654d *wḫꜣ n.k tꜣ jr jf.k*

głowa jest głową Horusa z Duat, o Niezniszczalny!" (TP zaklęcie 215 § 148a) – kompletne ciało faraona według wyobrażeń starożytnych Egipcjan w Tekstach Piramid [="Your head is that of Horus of the Duat, O Imperishable!" (PT spell 215 § 148a) – complete body of the pharaoh in beliefs of the ancient Egyptians as expressed in the Pyramid Texts], [in:] S. Rosik, P. Wiszewski (eds), *Akta Terra cognita. Przestrzeń i jej interpretacja w perspektywie studiów nad przeszłością. Interdyscyplinarne Spotkania Historyczne. Ad fontes IX, Środa Śląska, 22-24.10.2008*, Wrocław, in the press. Regarding different idea of the body decomposition as expressed in the Christian concepts see for instance: A. Paravicini Bagliani, *Il corpo del papa*, Roma 1994.

[13] Van Gennep, *Les rites de passage*, p. 184.

[14] It is implicit in ancient Egyptian religion that the after-life resembles life in this world very much, but without earthly toil. Moreover, ancient Egyptians created clear notions of the Beyond and propitious, blithe life of those justified there – what was rather unique in ancient times.

§ 655a *šzp n.k t.k j.ḫm ḫsḏ ḥnḳt.k j.ḫmt ꜥm3*
§ 655b *ꜥḥꜥ.k jr ꜥ3w ḫsf rḫwt*
[...]
§ 657e *ṯz ṯw NN pw nj mjjt.k*[15]

"Oho, oho! Raise yourself, o King, because you have received your head, your bones have been collected for you, your (body) members have been gathered for you, earth has been thrown off from your body. You have received your bread which does not grow mouldy and your beer which does not grow sour, thus stand at the door which restrain people.
[...]
Rise yourself, o King, for you have not died!" (*PT* spell 373 § 654a-655b; § 657e)

Furthermore it is clearly expressed in the Pyramid Texts:

§ 623c *ꜥḥꜥ.k ḥr nḫt.k jr.k wnt.k jr.k m b3ḥ*
§ 624a *3ḫ.k jr 3ḫjw nbw*

"Stand up in your strength and do that which you used to do before, because you are more spirit-like than all the spirits" (*PT* spell 365 §623c-624a).

§ 254b *j.gr n.k nṯrw d.n psḏt ꜥ.sn jr r.sn*
§ 254c *tp rdwj wꜥ pn jm.k ḏdw nṯr wḏ.f mdw n jtw nṯrw*
§ 255a *ꜥḥꜥ r ꜥ3wj 3ḫt jzn ꜥ3wj ḳbḥw*
§ 255b *ꜥḥꜥ.k ḫnt.sn gbb js ḫntj psḏt.f*
[...]
§ 256b *ꜥḥꜥ ꜥḥꜥ ḥ3.k ꜥḥꜥ sn.k ḥ3.k ꜥḥꜥ ns.k ḥ3.k*
§ 256c *nj sk.k nj tm.k*
§ 256d *nḫj rn.k ḫr rmṯ ḫpr rn.k ḫr nṯrw*

"The gods are silent for you, the Ennead have put their hands to their mouths, before this One in you, of whom the god says: 'He will give orders to the fathers of the gods! Stand at the doors of the horizon, open the doors of the Cool Water and stand at the head of them like Geb at the head of his Ennead. [...] Someone has stood behind you, your brother has stood behind you, the one you invoked has stood behind you – you will not perish, you will not stop existence, but your name will endure among people and your name will come into being among the gods." (*PT* spell 246 §254 b-255 b, §256 b-256d)

The pharaoh, as portrayed in the Egyptian Pyramid Texts, is the 'essence of every god' (cf. e.g. spells 589, 715) as only the son of Atum may be truly – as only Atum himself and Atum-the pharaoh can be:

§ 604a *wḏ.n nw NN n tm*
§ 604b *wḏ.n pg3 NN n šw*
§ 604c *ḏ.(f) j.wn.tj ꜥ3wj pt jpf n NN ḫr rmṯ*
§ 604d *nj rn.sn js*
§ 604e *nḏr n.k NN ḥr ꜥ.f šd n.k NN jr pt*
§ 604f *jm.f mt jr t3 mm rmṯ*

[15] Variant writing *mt.k*.

"Nu has commended the King to Atum, the Open-armed has commended the King to Shu, that he might have opened the yonder doors of the sky for the King, so say people who have no name. Take the King by his hand and take the King to the sky, that he may not die on earth among people." (*PT* spell 361 § 604)

To recapitulate in one phrase:

§ 1609a *wsjr NN ṯwt kꜣ n nṯrw nb*

"O Osiris the King, you are the *kꜣ*-essence of all the gods." (*PT* spell 589 § 1609a) it is clarified.

The climax of all ceremonies taking place in or in the vicinity of the tomb seems to be the departure from the human world – earth, pictured as climbing up the ladder, jumping up, flying aloft or being lifted by means of the gods' assistance and thus mounting up, ascending and entering the divine world. It is worth emphasising that the movement proceeded upwards, which suggests that the Egyptians located the divine Hereafter above the earth – a divine existence set apart from the human one. Following this and supported by the theory of the rites of passage,[16] one may presume that it was precisely here, in the tomb, that the so-called liminality stage ("neither here nor there" as described by V. Turner[17]) should have commenced. These acts have then a certain religious-ceremonial/ritualistic sense. Presumably the primary role was not only to cause the rebirth/revival of the deceased in the other world but also to render possible to him the perpetual, imperishable living in the Beyond in particular.

Therefore, in addition to the conception of J.P. Allen,[18] one may take into consideration another supplementary interpretation as a consequence of the above-described stages of the passage to the land of the gods. Consequently, the tomb may reflect the figurative peregrination of the pharaoh necessary to be undertaken to fulfil the aim, reach his place, his eternal destination. Moreover, the pyramids – or better to say – the tombs in general, might serve as the places of mediation between the worlds. One should perhaps dare to say that just the tomb supplied the king with the possibility of transition to the divine Beyond. Following this suggestion, it may be presumed that the place where the tomb was located should be understood as the place of entrance to the other world, which was not necessarily tantamount to reaching divine Beyond, but rather entering the way leading to it. Added to that the king turns out to be able to come to and fro. Thus the door to the Beyond was not closed after him irretrievably.

Irrefutably, the deceased must have undergone metamorphoses.[19] First into diverse entities, beings whose forms let the pharaoh perform various tasks while proceeding on the way to the Beyond, thus assuming various forms of being helping him achieve it and finally transform into the god of gods, the imperishable All, everlasting *tm*, comprising every single aspect of the world and every being in himself – positive as well as negative – the All interweaving seeming paradoxes, dichotomic opposites so characteristic of the religious thought and the ancient one especially. Thus it is supportive for the idea of the pharaoh existing in both spheres – the divine and the human concurrently.

The divinity of the king is corroborated by the fact the he has not died the death as the Pyramid Texts had ascertained (*PT* spell 438 § 810a).

---

[16] Van Gennep, *Les rites de passage*, pp. 209-236.
[17] Turner, *Forest of Symbols*, pp. 94-95.
[18] Allen, Reading a Pyramid, pp. 5-28.
[19] See footnote 11 above.

Furthermore, the idea of identity and unity of the pharaoh and the god-demiurge Atum develops into the concept of the king identified or equated with the god's son residing on the earth, i.e. the name 'son of Ra'. Consequently, this image seems to express bequeathing power, including life powers, to children. Heredity from father to son appears to be truly crucial for the ancient Egyptians.[20]

Concluding, one should recall how vital it is – while scrutinising ancient Egyptian beliefs on the Beyond and the routes leading to it – to take into consideration not only the complicated codes conveyed in magical and ritualistic acts, the preparation of the body and the tomb, but also verifying if the deceased reached the Beyond safely fulfilling his predestined lot at the head of the gods and the living simultaneously:

§ 458a *sbš pt ꜥnḫ spd(t) n wnjs js ꜥnḫ zꜣ spdt*
§ 458b *wꜥb.n n.f psḏtj*
§ 458c *m msḫtjw j.ḫm-sk*
§ 458d *nj sk pr wnjs r pt nj ḥtm nst wnjs jrt tꜣ*
[...]
§ 462a *nj mdw n wnjs r tꜣ ḫr rmṯ*
§ 462b *nj ḫbnt.f r pt ḫr nṯrw*
§ 462c *dr.n wnjs mdw.f sk.n wnjs jr.(f) jꜥ n pt*
§ 463a *spꜣ.n wp-wꜣwt wnjs jr pt mm snw.f nṯrw*
§ 463b *jṯ.n wnjs ꜥwj m smn*
§ 463c *ḥ.n wnjs ḏnḥ(wj.f) m ḏrt*
§ 463d *pꜣ pꜣ rmṯ (j).pꜣ wnjs r.f m ꜥ.ṯn*

"The sky has been cleared, and Sothis lives, for Unis is the living one – the son of Sothis, for whom the Two Enneads have cleansed the Imperishable Striker[21] for him. The house of Unis for the sky will not perish, the throne of Unis for the earth will not be annihilated.
[...]
There is not any word for Unis on the earth among people, there is not any accusation of him in the sky among the gods, for Unis has subdued the word involving him, Unis has nullified This-who-is-against ascending to the sky.
Wepwawat has made Unis fly to the sky among his brothers the gods. Unis has assumed arms as the arms of the goose, Unis has flapped his wing[s] as the one[s] of the kite. The flier has flown, o people: Unis has flown away from you." (*PT* spell 302 § 458a-d, § 462-463)

Consequently, one finds useful and thought provoking the analysis of Egyptian religious writings concurrently with their broad funerary context[22] using, for instance, scholarly methods developed by ethnolinguists under direction of Jerzy Bartmiński, Anna Pajdzińska and Ryszard Tokarski at the University of Maria Curie Skłodowska in Lublin,[23] which will be the next step of our study. At Lublin UMCS research has been conducted on notional categorisation, picturing of the world through language and profiling of notions. The ethnolinguistics, as a contemporary research programme, studies relations between language, history, social life and culture especially, namely it analyses 'culture in language'.[24] Moreover, worth mentioning are also studies of Slavonic antiquity conducted by V.V. Ivanov

[20] Popielska-Grzybowska, *The Pyramid Texts as a Source*, pp. 165, 173-178, 185.
[21] Concerning translation of *msḫtjw j.ḫm-sk ꜥs* "the imperishable Striker" cf. Allen, *Ancient PT*, p. 56.
[22] Regarding the so-called 'Sitz im Leben' ('life context') of some chosen notions in the Pyramid Texts cf. Popielska-Grzybowska, *The Pyramid Texts as a Source*, pp. 32, 138, 145.
[23] The research of ethnolinguists from Lublin was concentrated on analysis of the old Polish folk writings.
[24] J. Bartmiński, Etnolingwistyka słowiańska – próba bilansu, (=Slavonic Ethnolinguistics – an attempt of Balance), *Etnolingwistyka* 16 (2004), pp. 9-27.

and V.N. Toporov[25] within the structural paradigm using the notion of opposition, as for instance – and very relevant to our research – seeming paradoxes: life-death, sky-earth, sea-land, ancestor-descendant, sacrum-profanum.[26]

The study presented herein – as mentioned above – is of preliminary character. The topic needs further thorough scrutiny in various contexts of diverse cultures,[27] including an analysis of the so-called 'life context' of this religious concept as pictured in written and material sources.[28]

[25] V.V. Ivanov, V.N. Toporov, *Slavjanskie jazykovye modelirujushchie systemy*, Moskva 1965.

[26] Bartmiński, *Etnolingwistyka* 16 (2004), pp. 13-14. See also Popielska-Grzybowska, *The Pyramid Texts as a Source*, pp. 82, 178, 191-194.

[27] Cf. e.g. J. Holm, J. Bowker (eds), *Rites of Passage*, Themes in Religion Studies, London 1994 or R.L. Grimes, *Deeply into the Bone: Re-Inventing Rites of Passage*, Berkeley 2000.

[28] See footnote 22 above.